

one of the earliest programming languages but it no longer is widely used professionally, while AppleScript is solely used with macOS. AWK is a text processing language which is losing its war with Perl, another text processing language.

Ada is a programming language that supports both imperative and object-oriented programming paradigms, with safety and security as the main concerns. GNAT is an open source compiler for Ada which is part of the GNU Compiler Collections (GCC). Ada has the support of a small but stable developer community. The programming language Ada is named after Ada Lovelace, the daughter of Lord Byron (famous English poet). Ada Lovelace is considered a pioneer in computer programming for her work with Charles Babbage while trying to develop his unfinished yet famous Analytical Engine. Even though I have selected Ada, do remember that assembly languages are very important in programming but it is not single programming language; rather, they are a family of programming languages.

B for BASIC

There are programming languages called B and BCPL which influenced the development of the C programming language, which makes them rather important. But for the letter B, I chose BASIC (Beginner's All-purpose Symbolic Instruction Code). BASIC has influenced a lot of other programming languages like Visual Basic, VB.NET, etc. But the single largest contribution of BASIC is that for the first time people with no scientific background could start to program, by using it.

C for C

This is one letter where the number of influential programming languages is very high. There are programming languages like C++, C#, Clojure, COBOL, etc. But here the choice is

obvious – it is none other than C, which was originally developed in 1972 by Dennis Ritchie at Bell Labs. Even after almost 50 years of existence, C is still widely used professionally as well as in academia. So, justifying the choice of C is unnecessary.

D for Dart

There is a programming language called D, heavily influenced by C++. But my choice is Dart, an open source, object-oriented programming language developed by Google, and released under the BSD license.

Dart was featured as a promising programming language in an article in *Open Source For You*. Please visit <https://opensourceforu.com/2019/03/yet-another-top-ten-list-of-popular-programming-languages/>.

E for Erlang

Erlang is an open source programming language developed by Ericsson and is licensed under the Apache license 2.0. Erlang is a functional programming language. There are also other options like Eiffel and Elixir. Eiffel is an objected-oriented programming language, whereas Elixir is a functional programming language heavily influenced by Erlang itself. Since Erlang has recent stable releases, I have chosen it over Elixir. As an aside, there is an open source programming language called Ezhil, which uses the Tamil script for writing programs.

F for Fortran

There are programming languages called F, F#, FoxPro, etc, but Fortran is my choice for representing the letter F. It is the oldest programming language chosen in this article, yet it has had a stable release in the past one year. Fortran was originally used for scientific and numeric computing. GFortran is the Fortran compiler provided by GCC, making Fortran a truly open source programming language.

G for Go

Go (also called Golang) is developed by Google. It is a popular programming language that features in the top ten list of many rankings. Go is similar to C, but with added features for security and garbage collection. Go has multiple open source compilers with BSD licences. There is no other programming language starting with the letter G worth mentioning other than Groovy, which is an object-oriented programming language heavily influenced by Java.

H for Haskell

Haskell is a functional programming language that was developed in 1990. The Glasgow Haskell Compiler (GHC) is a popular open source compiler for Haskell released under the New BSD licence. Haskell figures relatively high in many rankings. The Hindawi Programming System is a collection of open source programming languages that use Hindi, Bengali and Gujarati scripts for writing programs.

I for Icon

There are hardly any significant programming languages starting with this letter. I have chosen Icon, a dynamic programming language influenced by SNOBOL, which is much older. But so far, this is the only letter in our programming languages alphabet the removal of which will not affect the programming world much.

J for Java

The letter J in our programming language alphabet is definitely reserved for Java. The quote, "You can love me or hate me but you can't ignore me," is absolutely true for Java. Appreciative or critical, no real programmer can ignore Java. I don't think I need to justify my choice and so I rest my case. But JavaScript is also worth an honourable mention. JavaScript is an interpreted scripting language which is a permanent member in the Top Ten lists of most rankings.